

THE RECOMMENDED DOMAIN NAME REGISTRARS

A domain name registrar is a company that allows you to purchase and register domain names. All domain name registrars are accredited by ICANN (Internet Corporation for Assigned Names and Numbers), a non-profit organization responsible for managing domain names.

Domain names make the internet easy to use for everyone. Without domain names, you'll have to enter long strings of numbers called IP addresses to visit websites.

To make domain names widely available, ICANN allows companies to apply for accreditation and become a domain registrar.

These companies then compete with each other to sell domain name licenses which allows you to get better service and tools when you purchase your domain name.

Note: Not all domain registrars have the license to sell all domain name extensions. For example, some domain registrars can only sell domain names with country-specific extensions (like .co.zm, .zm etc).

Each domain registrar may offer different services along with the domain name registration. Some registrar may

offer cheap domains as their promotional offer while others may give free add-ons to attract customers.

When choosing the best domain name registrar, we look at the following four criteria:

Pricing and Registration Period

The first thing you want to check is the domain name prices. For example, some domain registrars may offer low prices upfront for the first year registration, but their renewal prices can be different and significantly higher.

You can register a domain name for a minimum period of 1 year. However, some companies may require a higher registration period like 2 years minimum. You can register a domain name for up to 10 years at a time.

If you are buying a new web address, then we recommend registering your domain name for 1 year. You can turn on automatic renewal, so your domain does not expire.

You also need to check for any additional fees for domain transfers, renewal, and other charges.

Domain Transfers

Domain names can be moved from one domain registrar to another. Normally, you wouldn't need to transfer your domain name right away, but if you're unhappy with your domain registrar, then this option should be easily available.

The first thing you need to keep in mind is that you cannot transfer a domain name during the first 60 days of the

registration. This initial period is decided by ICANN. After that, you are allowed to move it to any other registrar that you want.

Most domain registrars make it easy to transfer domain names without any extra fee. However, some may try to make it complicated or charge an extra fee to remove domain lock.

Make sure that you review the domain transfer policy before you buy a domain name from a registrar.

Domain Expiration Policies

Domain names are registered for a specific duration. You can renew your domain registration before its expiration date. However, if you forgot to renew your domain name, then it expires and anyone can register it.

For businesses, this means someone can take over their domain name. To make sure that this doesn't happen, you can set up auto-renewals for your domain name.

Even if you use the automatic renewal feature, it is a good idea to check your domain registrars expiration policy. Some domain registrars offer a grace period even after the expiration. This grace period allows you to renew your expired domain name.

Whereas bad domain registration services will immediately auction your expired domain to the highest bidder.

We have heard dozens of horror stories of business owners losing their domain name because their credit card expired,

and their registrar did not have a grace period. This is one of the many reasons why it's extremely important to choose the right domain name registrar.

Add-on Services

You may also want to review what other services are offered by your domain registrar. While you may not need these services right now, it is good to know that they have them.

These add-on services may include domain privacy, domain parking, extended expiration protection, and more. Some domain registrars may even sell WordPress hosting service, email hosting service, website builders, email marketing services, and more.

Now that you have known what it takes to have a domain name, let's look at the recommended domain name REGISTRARS.

Godaddy

GoDaddy is one of the oldest and most popular domain registration company. They manage more than 84 million domain names for over 20 million customers.

They offer a wide variety of popular domain name extensions to choose from. Their prices are highly competitive, and you may even get a significant discount on the first year of your domain's registration.

For professionals, GoDaddy offers premium Domain club membership that offers discounted domain pricing. This makes sense if you're registering or managing hundreds of domain names.

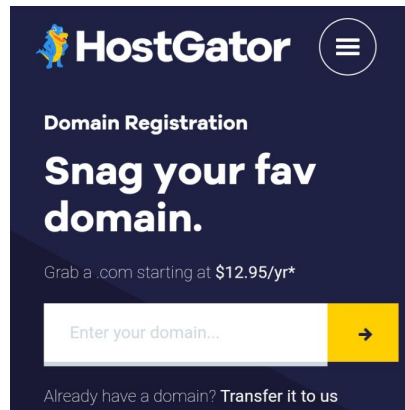


GoDaddy has a powerful easy to use domain management interface which allows you to transfer your domain name, change name servers, update contact information, manage bulk domain renewals, and customize various other domain settings.

GoDaddy also has a suite of other web services including hosting, website builder, email marketing, and more.

Hostgator

Like I said in the previous page, Hostgator for me has been one of the best domain name registrars, Hostgator offers several hosting plans and you can sign up for periods of between 1 month and 3 years. If you sign up for 1 month you will pay your hosting fees monthly. If you sign up for 1 year you will pay your hosting fees annually. As you might expect, the longer you sign up for, the cheaper it becomes. And you can pay via credit/debit card or PayPal.



It's a popular company offering website owners a one-stop shop for domain names and shared website hosting. They offer a nice selection of extensions, domain privacy, and easy to use DNS management tools.

They have an easy to use domain search tool that helps you quickly find a suitable domain name for your business. Their domain management area is beginner friendly and well documented which makes it easy to transfer domains if you need to.

Aside from domain name and hosting, they have also introduced a brand new drag & drop website builder called Gator. They're offering free domain name and hosting with all of their website builder plans.

Bluehost

Bluehost is one of the largest hosting companies in the world, and they are an official WordPress hosting partner. As part of their web hosting service, they also offer domain name registration.



With our Bluehost coupon code, WPBeginner users can get a free domain name, free SSL certificate, and a discount on web hosting which is a perfect deal for anyone looking to make a new website.

Basically, you can get started for \$2.75 per month, and get a free new domain name.

Namecheap

Namecheap is another top domain registrar on the market. They have a powerful domain search tool that helps you find the right domain name and makes suggestions when your preferred domain name is not available.



They also offer domain add-on services like domain privacy and premium DNS. Their domain management area is clean, but it's not as user-friendly as GoDaddy's new interface.

One nice thing about NameCheap is that they offer free whois privacy with all their domain purchases.

However, the support system is sometimes not good, I once used NameCheap creating a website for my client but I ended up transferring the domain name to other

providers because I had too many issues logging into their domain management panel.

DreamHost

DreamHost is another popular domain name registrar and web hosting service provider. They are offering our readers a free domain name with domain privacy included for anyone signing up for their Shared Unlimited hosting plan.



You can also register a domain name without buying hosting through them for \$8.99 / year which also includes free private registration.

DreamHost offers 400+ TLDs and comes with all domain management tools that you can expect from a large domain provider like DreamHost.

Aside from shared hosting, Dreamhost also offers managed WordPress hosting called DreamPress which is great for larger websites.

Domain.com

Started in 2000, Domain.com is one of the most popular domain name registrar on the planet. They allow you to register all top level domain name extensions (TLDs) and even dozens of country code top level domains (ccTLDs).



Domain.com has a quick domain search tool that you can use for your domain name research. Their search also shows you premium domains as well.

You get access to all domain management tools that you would expect from a top domain registrar including private registration, whois privacy protection, free whois, bulk registration, easy transfers, easy DNS management, email account, email forwarding, and other additional services. You can even purchase web hosting from them if you like. If you have any questions, then you can contact their helpful customer support team via phone support, live chat or email. They also have an extensive knowledge base with helpful guides.

My final thoughts on the domain name registrars.

There are literally hundreds of other domain registrars and resellers in the market that we have not included in the list including Hover, Google Domains, Tucows, 1&1 Ionos, Shopify, eNom, Name.com, Namesilo, Porkbun, etc.

The reason is because they all primarily offer the same services, and we want to make it easy for our users to pick the best and most secure domain registrar without causing choice paralysis.

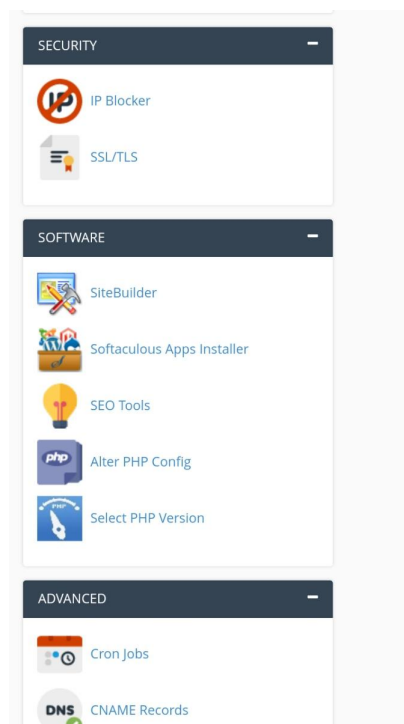
In my opinion, Domain.com is the best domain registrar in the market for small businesses as well as large companies. They offer the most reasonable pricing and has all the features.

If you're looking to build a website, then you can get a free domain name from both **Bluehost** and **Hostigator** when you signup for their web hosting.

They are both among the best web hosting companies on the planet, and they also offer step by step website set up for any type of website including real estate, small business site, online store, and many more.

THE CONTROL PANEL NAVIGATION

What Is a Control Panel? A web hosting control panel is a graphical user interface (GUI) or, in some cases, a web-based interface, that is accessible online and provides tools for managing a website, the web hosting account, and sometimes the server. The moment you log in to the control panel, you will find different softwares that you can use to manage and control your website.



Make sure you effectively take charge of a website hosting environment and make sure the website control panel you choose offers the following essential, basic functions.

Domain and DNS Management

You depend on domains to access website resources. Hence, your control panel should have a section that lets you manage everything about the domains you're hosting

on your server. This includes new add-ons and subdomains, or managing existing ones.

Subdomains

Subdomains allow you to create a separate website area or an entirely new website. All while still using your main domain name. So it can be useful to add a prefix to your website domain name, such as support.domain.com. Your control panel needs to allow you to create as many subdomains as you need. You have the choice to make!!!

Add-on domains

Most control panels will give you the option to add a number of domains to the hosting environment. You'll find these as "Add-on domains". Now, you can choose to assign an add-on domain to a specific website. Or you can simply park it if you currently don't want the domain to point to any website. Note that a parked domain can point to an existing website. So in this case, every request for that domain is simply redirected to another website of your choice.

DNS Management

Can you imagine if all your DNS data was scattered? You can usually host all the DNS data for a domain on your hosting environment itself. Including the entire range of DNS records, like nameserver and A records, MX records and TXT records. The right hosting control panel for you will allow you to fully customize DNS for each add-on domain you host.

File Manager

Make sure that your control panel has the file manager, Organization is key. How can you keep track of all your the files on your server? You need an easy way to upload, remove and manage these files. So your control panel should present a GUI that enables quick and easy file management. The simpler, the better. Because whether you use the control management system (CMS) such as WordPress, or not, file management is a basic daily task for admins. Solving CMS issues is also much quicker with a file manager. There is an alternative – enter FTP (File Transfer Protocol), still supported by most control panels, to be honest. But FTP requires using a separate software application which you'll need to set up on the side.

Mailbox Management

You'll have multiple email accounts (also known as mailboxes) associated with each domain. Your control panel should come to the rescue here too by letting you create, remove and otherwise manage these accounts. It's common for web hosting packages to include POP3 or even IMAP email free of charge.

Mail forwarding is another important feature you should look out for. Doesn't matter whether you are forwarding to an internal email account or an email account hosted elsewhere. Another common practice for control panels is allowing you to configure anti-SPAM solutions (including

DKIM, SPF and DMARC). This is because it lets you monitor and protect incoming emails against blacklists and open-source filtering databases.

Security: TLS/SSL

The ability to manage TLS/SSL is an essential feature of your control panel. These encryption features prevent your confidential data from getting intercepted. So you can protect user credentials and credit card numbers that hackers can effortlessly steal, via something as common as an unsecured wifi connection.

Automation

There's only so much time in a day, right? And you don't want to be working round the clock. Automating server maintenance is useful for system administrators because it frees up time they can use for other tasks.

Many control panels allow you to use Cron as a scheduler, which runs scripts at specific times on specific days. Great for automating server tasks like database view updates, performing backups and checking your site for broken links.

My final thoughts on the Control Panel navigation.

You'll find control panels included in almost all hosting packages. The control panel your host uses is unlikely to be the most important factor you consider when choosing a host, but it's an important consideration nonetheless.

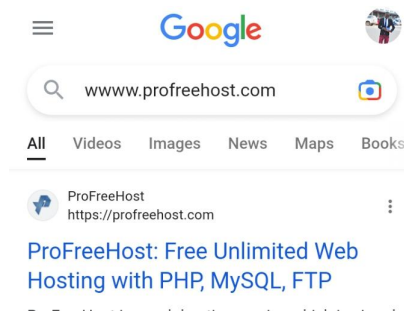
And as with any software product, the optimal way to evaluate a website control panel is to experience it

yourself. Most panels offer a live online preview or free trial which helps you evaluate the functionality and GUI user-friendliness.

It's a good idea to try and perform the routine tasks you regularly perform and to compare how long it takes you. A visually-stunning control panel is not necessarily the most effective tool. You ought to try it and if it does not really work out well, leave it and go for the other one.

WORDPRESS INSTALLATION

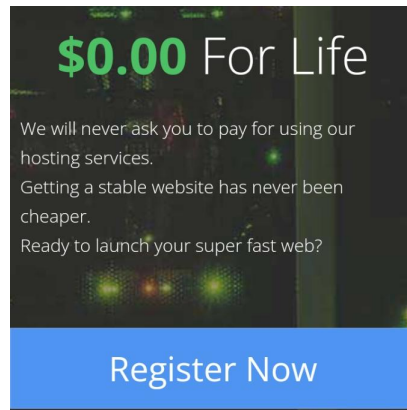
What we're going to do now is to install the WordPress software on your domain and hosting account. The good news is that you only have to do this once, so just get through this step and you're on your way to a great website! **Now for the sake of learning and practice, we are going to use profreehost, a web hosting provider that provides a free domain name and free web hosting services. I don't recommend you using profreehost when creating a website for your client or even your own website. However, the process which will be going through when installing wordpress is just the same process which you have to use whenever you are installing wordpress using any of those webhosting providers that I earlier Recommended.** If you already have a hosting account with another provider, check whether they have the cPanel (stands for 'control panel') interface. If so, this set of instructions will likely apply to your host, too. If you are with a different host and they don't have cPanel, ask their Technical Support for instructions on how to install WordPress. Okay, so let's start, I will walk you through everything STEP by STEP. Click on this link www.profreehost.com after click on that link it will take you to this picture showing below.



When you tend to have that screen, click on those words showing in blue color or just the link on top of those words. You will then have something like this

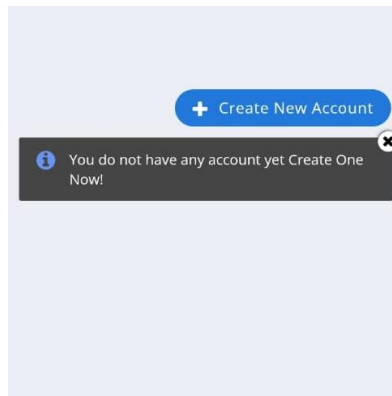


Immediately you have this screen, just scroll down a bit and you're going to find this



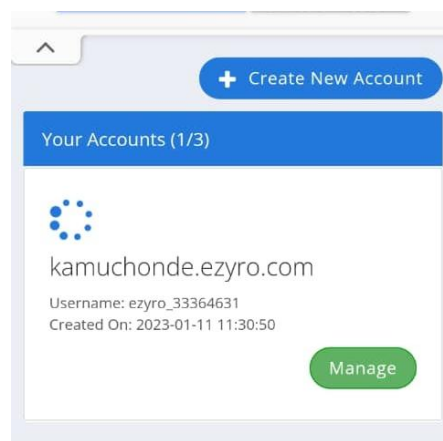
Have you seen that with this web hosting provider you will not be able to spend not even a single dollar for their service. It's entirely free \$0.00. Just scroll down and click on Register Now just as it is showing on the picture above.

Once you click on Register now, you will again have the screen where you will be required to put your email address and creating a website. Once you are done with that process, click on Register now and they will send you the verification email, go to your email inbox and you will find the verification email from profreehost. So click on the verification email so that you confirm that it's really you.

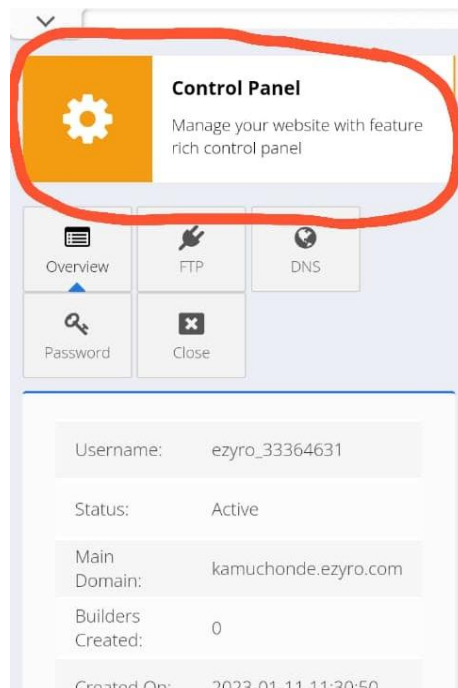


After verifying your email, you will be directed to this screen where you will be required to create your account, meaning that when you click on create new account, you will have the provision of typing your domain name. Now by default, profreehost only provide [.com](#) domain name extension under three domains.

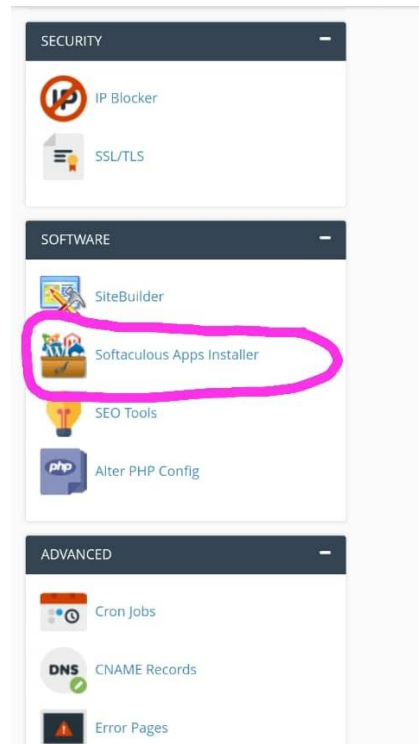
([Liveblog365.com](#), [ezyro.com](#) and [unaux.com](#)). So when for instance I choose kamuchonde as my domain name, I will have to include [kamuchonde.ezyro.com](#) or any of the other mentioned domains. However, I don't recommend using liveblog 365.com because it doesn't just look so professional.



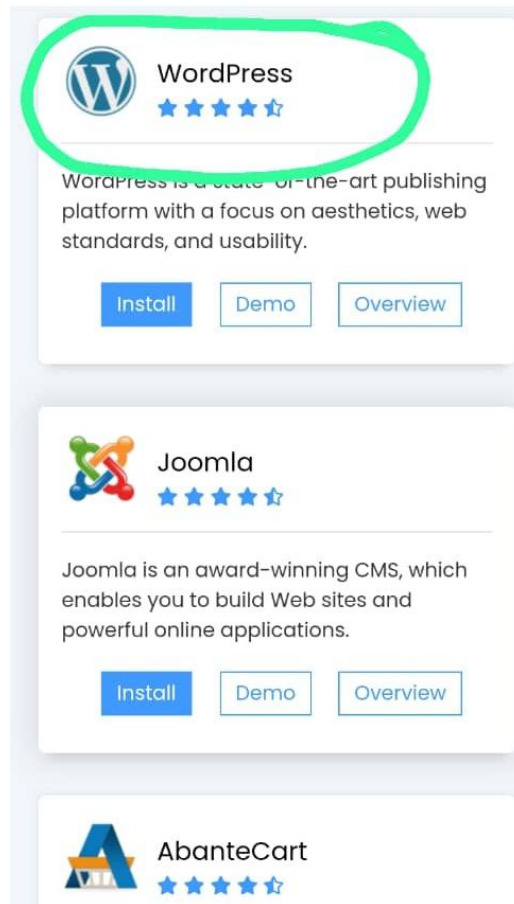
Okay! So if you look at the picture you will discover that kamuchonde.ezyro.com has been created, so if your domain name has also been created, just click on the green button where it's written **Manage**. Immediately you click on manage, you will be directed to the other screen where you will be able to find the control panel.



Once you have access to the control panel, click on it and you will then have a screen where you will find so many softwares. Now the software that is going to help us install WORDPRESS is called **Softiculous Apps Installer**. Here it is.



I hope you're following, lets make progress. So when you find the softiculous apps installer, click on it. Once you click on it, you will then be directed to the other screen where you will be able to install WORDPRESS.



Okay, so once you have the WORDPRESS just as it showing on the picture, click on the word [install](#)

The moment you click on the word install, you will be taken to yet another important part where you will be required to create your admin username and your password.

Admin Account

Admin Username

Isaac

Admin Password

..... Show

Good (47/100)

Admin Email

shepmacontractors@gmail.com

Choose Language

Select Language

English

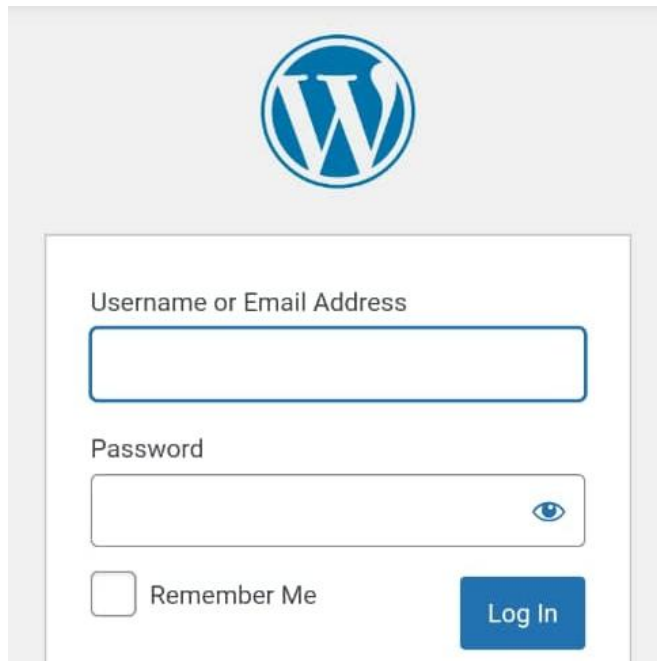
How to login and out of the wordpress

Whenever you want to work on your website you need to login into WordPress by typing the following into your browser: <http://yourdomain.com/wp-admin/> (where ‘yourdomain.com’is your actual domain name.

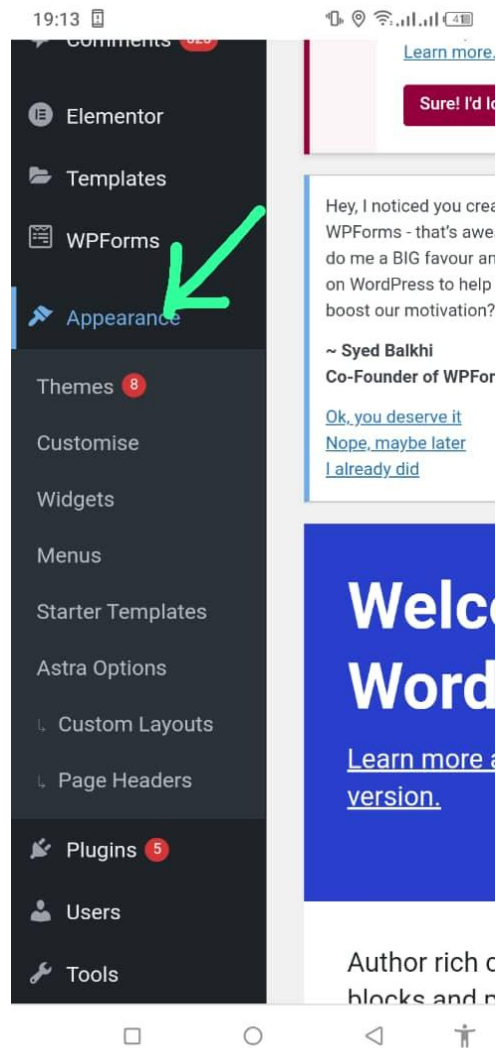
In my case this is kamuchonde.com) so it will be

<http://kamuchonde.ezyro.com/wp-admin/>

Now when I click on that link this is what I will have



Whenever I want to have access to the wordpress dashboard, I will need to put my username and the password I created when installing wordpress. That's the only way you can as well have access to your wordpress dashboard. Here is the picture showing the wordpress dashboard.



When you successfully have access to your wordpress dashboard, you need to go to **Appearance**, click on it. Once you click on the word appearance, you will then see the word themes, by default, wordpress comes with other themes already installed and activated like twenty twenty. But I always recommend the theme called **Astra**. So once you click on themes, click on add New. Then you will have the provision of searching any theme you would like to use. Search for the theme called Astra. Once you find it, click on install, after it finishes installing, click on **activate**.

Now when you reach at this stage you will be required to choose the page builder and I recommend using **Elementor**. So click on **Elementor**, thereafter, you will be taken to the other screen where you will be required to choose the starter template of your choice, choose the template which is in line with the type of the website you want to create and thereafter import it.

Now after importing your starter template, you will be astonished due to the fact that the template comes with the default information that does not even make sense. That's the other interesting part of you now starting to remove every default information and have it replaced with your own information until you have a professional, beautiful and exciting Website.